the voiceless groups like the indigenous people, women and children to express their views. This further got a boost with the organization of an alternative NGO forum in Copenhagen, parallel to the UN World Summit for Social Development there in 1995. The *Alternative Declaration* produced by the NGO Forum at the Copenhagen Summit highlighted the principles of community participation and empowerment. Equity, participation, self-reliance, role of women and youths and sustainability were also given importance. The Summit Declaration condemned economic liberalism and identified trade liberalization and privatization as the causes of concentration of wealth. It also demanded immediate cancellation of debt, improved terms of trade, transparency and accountability of IMF and the World Bank, and the regulation of the activities of the multinationals.[4]

Therefore, the mainstream debate is now centred around sustainable development. The concept of development now not only stands broadened but also related to environment and sustainability. This brings us to the discussion of sustainable development at length.